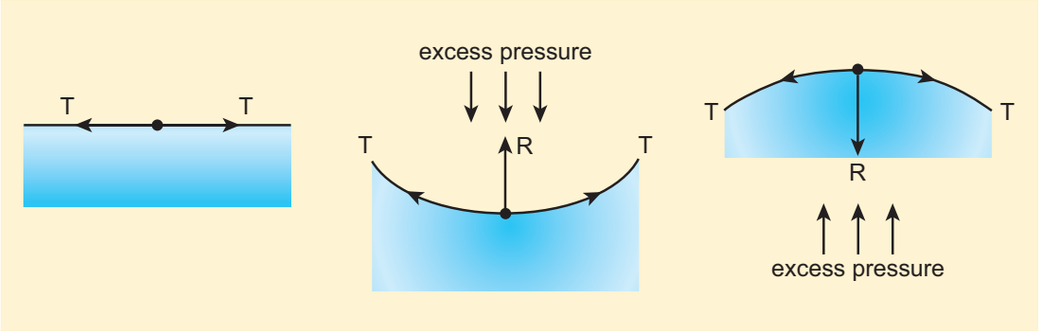


Figure7.27 Excess of pressure across a liquid surface

opposite directions. Hence, the resultant force on the molecule is zero. Therefore, in the case of a plane liquid surface, the pressure on the liquid side is equal to the pressure on the vapour side.

ii) When the liquid surface is curved, every molecule on the liquid surface experiences forces (F_T, F_T) due to surface tension along the tangent to the surface. Resolving these forces into rectangular components, we find that horizontal components cancel out each other while vertical components get added up. Therefore, the resultant force normal to the surface acts on the curved surface of the liquid. Similarly, for a convex surface, the resultant force is directed inwards towards the centre of curvature, whereas the resultant force is directed outwards from the centre of curvature for a concave surface. Thus, for a curved liquid surface in equilibrium, the pressure on its concave side is greater than the pressure on its convex side.

Excess of pressure inside a bubble and a liquid drop:

The small bubbles and liquid drops are spherical because of the forces of surface tension. The fact that a bubble or a liquid drop does not collapse due to the combined effect indicates that the pressure inside a bubble or a drop is greater than that outside it.

1) Excess of pressure inside air bubble in a liquid.

Consider an air bubble of radius R inside a liquid having surface tension T as shown in Figure 7.28 (a). Let P_1 and P_2 be the pressures outside and inside the air bubble, respectively. Now, the excess pressure inside the air bubble is $\Delta P = P_2 - P_1$.

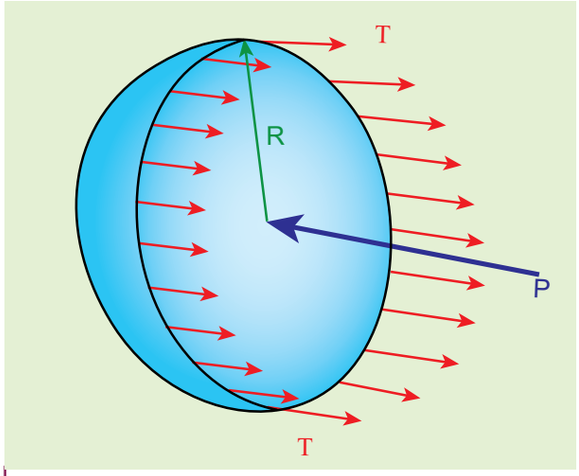


Figure 7.28. (a) Air bubble

In order to find the excess pressure inside the air bubble, let us consider the forces acting on the air bubble. For the hemispherical portion of the bubble, considering the forces acting on it, we get,

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